



— AI DERMATOLOGY · BUILT FOR AFRICAN SKIN

GlowScan **Africa**

A mobile AI platform that gives African patients an instant, accurate skin assessment — and puts them directly in front of a real dermatologist. Built on the skin the rest of the industry ignores.

Founder & CEO

Demise Essawe

Location

Douala, Cameroon

Prepared for

FasterCapital

Date

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Dermatology AI was never built for **this skin.**

● The data gap

The datasets behind today's AI skin tools barely contain darker skin. In the widely-used **PAD-UFES-20** dataset, Fitzpatrick type VI skin is **0.07%** of images. In **Fitzpatrick17k**, it's **~4%**. Only **3 of 54** public dermatology datasets even record skin type at all.

Source: Alipour, Burke & Courtney, "Skin Type Diversity in Skin Lesion Datasets," Current Dermatology Reports, 2024

● The access gap

Even where AI isn't the bottleneck, dermatologists are. South Africa — one of the continent's better-resourced systems — has roughly **3–4 dermatologists per million people**, versus **~10/M in the UK**, **~36/M in the US**, and **~65/M in Germany**. Most of Sub-Saharan Africa is worse.

Source: Tiwary et al., "Counting dermatologists in South Africa," British Journal of Dermatology, 2022

Result: hundreds of millions of people whose skin conditions are misread by AI trained on someone else's skin — and who, even with a correct read, have almost nowhere to go next.

One product, two sides of the same gap.

● GlowScan (B2C)

Free AI skin analysis in under 30 seconds, from a phone photo — trained and continuously improved on real African skin, collected since **August 2026**. Every user with a concerning result is routed to a real dermatologist, not left with an app's opinion.

● GlowScan DERM (B2B)

A digital practice for the dermatologist: patient files, AI-assisted clinical reasoning, auto-generated reports sent straight to the patient on WhatsApp. It turns a doctor's phone into a full remote practice — and turns every GlowScan referral into a paying consultation.

GlowScan doesn't diagnose. GlowScan documents, triages, and connects — the doctor decides, always.

From a photo to a paid consultation — in four steps.

STEP 1

Free scan

Patient photographs their skin.
GlowScan returns an instant Glow Score and indicative read.



STEP 2

Smart triage

Low-confidence or concerning score
→ GlowScan recommends a licensed dermatologist.



STEP 3

Patient books & pays

Patient finds the doctor's public GlowScan profile, reads reviews, books and pays online.



STEP 4

Consult & deliver

Doctor consults, GlowScan documents. Signed PDF report is sent to the patient on WhatsApp.

No marketing spend, real distribution

Every free B2C scan is a lead for a paying doctor on the platform — the two products fund each other's growth loop.

Doctor economics are simple

Dermatologists keep the majority of every consultation fee, plus a subscription-free 14-day trial to prove value before paying anything.

Early, real, and organic.

1,006

Unique visitors, 30+ countries

256

AI skin analyses completed

32%

User retention rate

2.2

Analyses per returning user

18,800 FCFA

Revenue on Day 1 of the new consultation + product funnel

4

Pilot dermatologists live, across Cameroon, Benin & DRC

100%

Organic — zero paid acquisition to date

Every one of these numbers came from word of mouth and direct outreach — the growth engine hasn't even been turned on yet.

An official stage in front of 500 dermatologists — and a quiet market.

- **SODAF Congress — October 2, 2026**

GlowScan Africa has a confirmed, signed invitation to present at the SODAF Congress in Ouagadougou — the largest French-speaking dermatology congress in Africa, ~500 specialists in attendance. Official letter signed by Pr Nessimé Nina KORSAGA/SOME, President of SOBUDEC.

- **The funding window is thin — and that's the opening**

Only ~36 African health startups raised funding in H1 2026, totaling under \$20M — the slowest period in 8 years. Fewer credible, revenue-generating healthtech teams are being funded, which means less noise for the ones that are.

Source: Africa Health Ventures newsletter #28, 2026

GlowScan is not pitching a concept at SODAF — it's demonstrating a live product to the exact audience it depends on: the dermatologists it needs on the platform.

Four revenue lines, one dataset compounding underneath.

LINE	MECHANIC	PRICE
DERM subscription B2B, per dermatologist	Monthly SaaS fee, 14-day free trial	10,000 FCFA / mo
Online consultation Per consult	Fixed fee, doctor keeps 60% (2,880 FCFA), GlowScan keeps 40% (1,920 FCFA)	4,800 FCFA
B2C analysis Consumer	Free — the acquisition & data engine that feeds the other three lines	Free
Product commission Cosmetics marketplace	Commission on every skincare product sold through the platform	% of sale

A large, growing market — with Africa still uncounted.

\$41.08B

Global tele dermatology market by 2030, growing
17.9% CAGR (2025–2030)

Grand View Research, 2025

86.3%

Of Cameroon's population has a mobile connection
— a mobile-first product's core precondition

DataReportal, "Digital 2025: Cameroon"

\$1.4T

Mobile money transaction value across Sub-Saharan
Africa in 2025 — the payment rail GlowScan already
runs on

GSMA, State of the Industry Report, 2025

No third-party report sizes the African tele dermatology market specifically — that gap is itself the opportunity. GlowScan is building the dataset that would define it.

The moat isn't the app. It's the dataset underneath it.

● A living, proprietary dataset

Every scan since August 3, 2026 adds to a growing dataset of real African skin (Fitzpatrick IV–VI) — the exact population global AI dermatology tools were never trained on. This compounds: the more it's used, the harder it is to copy.

● Distribution built into the product

Global players sell an app. GlowScan sells access to paying patients — every free B2C scan is a direct lead for a dermatologist already on the platform. Global competitors have no local doctor network to route into.

● Local trust, local rails

Mobile Money payments (MTN & Orange), WhatsApp delivery, French-language clinical workflows — built for how care is actually paid for and delivered in Francophone Africa, not adapted from a US product.

● Clinical credibility, early

4 pilot dermatologists live across 3 countries, and an invited keynote at Africa's largest Francophone dermatology congress — validation most pre-seed health startups don't have before their first raise.

From a skin photo to a full biological Glow Score.



The long-term platform integrates hormonal, glycemic and nutritional biomarkers via lab partnerships — turning a skin scan into a full early-signal health check, on the population the global health data industry has the least data on.

Built solo. Shipped daily.

Demise Essawe — Founder & CEO

22 years old, solo full-stack developer and CEO. Designed, built, and ships the entire product — B2C and DERM — alone: React/TypeScript frontend, Node/Express backend, PostgreSQL, deployed on Railway. Every feature in this deck was built by one person, in one city, with \$0 outside funding to date.

Operating discipline

Daily execution blocks (finance, product, medical network, content), an honest internal audit standard with zero self-flattery, and a hard separation between the consumer and medical products in the codebase and in the data. This is not a side project — it's run like a company from day one.

"This is not luck. This is discipline."

— THE ASK

\$20,000 to convert momentum into a funded team.

\$20,000

RAISE AMOUNT

15%

EQUITY OFFERED

~\$133K

POST-MONEY VALUATION

Product & AI / dataset ops



40%

Dermatologist network growth



25%

Growth & first paid acquisition



20%

Legal, compliance & ops



15%

Proposed allocation — open to discussion with FasterCapital based on diligence and any parallel instruments already in motion.



Let's put an AI dermatologist in every pocket in Africa.

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